

UTT Chapter 17 Assignment

Greetings!

Your last letter helped me out a ton when writing my economics paper. Thanks a lot! Now I just have to focus on surviving these last few weeks of the semester. Elections are held next week, and finals are held the following three weeks. Surprisingly, this week will be relatively low key, like the calm before the storm. My professors have been helpful with supplying extra office hours in preparation for finals. In fact I met with my History of Western Civilization professor yesterday to talk about some questions I had concerning next week's studies on the French Revolution. He is an interesting old man with a British accent and a penchant for wearing tweed coats and bow ties.

During our conversation, I mentioned how his class has me considering perhaps majoring or minoring in history. He described what it was like to be a historian, digging in archives and spending long hours poring over forgotten texts. He also related his favorite travel memories while researching his latest book. Apparently historians travel the world and learn many languages. An overwhelming topic of our conversation was the method of viewing and analyzing history. Essentially, he was explaining how historians view the overarching theme of history. He views history through the lens of progression. He related it to evolutionary theory. History is always changing, or progressing, as human beings evolve. When I asked him what the end goal of the progression was, he merely chuckled and replied, "progress." Evolution has no purpose, only direction.

The professor's view of history doesn't seem to align with what Christianity says about human depravity and God's redemptive plan for humanity. I told the professor I believed history had meaning and purpose to it. He challenged to me prove it. I told him I was a Christian, but he didn't seem to accept that as an answer. He gave me several books to read on the topic by authors he described as leading humanist and Marxist scholars of history. I assume he means Secular Humanists. I want to be able to speak with him further on these topics, but I need your help understanding the subject better. **What is the Secularist view of history?** Also, **what is the Marxist view of history?** He has mentioned in class before that some historians promote the idea that history is only the interpretations we impart onto the subject. This sounds like something Paige, as a Postmodernist, would say. **How does Postmodernism approach the discipline of history?** Nathan is taking this class with me, so I want to be prepared to talk with him too. **How does New Spirituality view history?** I also wonder how similar Islam is to Christianity with regards to history. **How do Islamic and Christian views of history differ?**

Thanks again for all your help. I appreciate how much time you spend aiding my understanding of all these different topics. You rock!

See ya!

-Doug